



Government of Odisha



ODISHA
THINK INDIA, THINK ODISHA.

ANNUAL REPORT

2025-26





Koraput
Coffee...

Contents...

1.	Introduction ~~~~~	01
2.	Organisation Details ~~~~~	02
3.	OTDC ~~~~~	03
4.	State Institute Of Hotel Management (SIHM) ~~~~~	04
5.	Objectives ~~~~~	05
6.	Sector Development Strategy ~~~~~	05
7.	Highlights Of The Activities ~~~~~	06
8.	Odisha Tourism – Digital Initiatives ~~~~~	07
9.	Tourism Events & Trade Fairs ~~~~~	09
10.	Tourism Sector Overview ~~~~~	15
11.	Tourism Budget Overview ~~~~~	17
12.	Major Actions/Activities ~~~~~	21
13.	Training & Capacity Building ~~~~~	49
14.	Introduction Of Niche Tourism Products ~~~~~	50
15.	Awards and Recognitions ~~~~~	53
16.	Recognition Of Excursion Agencies ~~~~~	54

Introduction...

Tourism has been a key focus area of the Government of Odisha since the establishment of the Tourism and Cultural Affairs Department in 1973. Over the decades, the Department has evolved through various administrative reforms and has functioned as the Department of Tourism since March 2018.

As a highly labour-intensive sector, tourism plays a vital role in economic development, employment generation and regional prosperity. It creates significant direct and indirect livelihood opportunities while contributing to the flow of investment and income across communities through the multiplier effect of tourism.

The Department of Tourism functions through a composite administrative structure comprising the Directorate of Tourism and a network of 32 Tourist Offices across the State and New Delhi. It is supported by two affiliated institutions—the Odisha Tourism Development Corporation (OTDC), established in 1979, and the State Institute of Hotel Management (SIHM), Balangir, which imparts quality hospitality education and skill development.

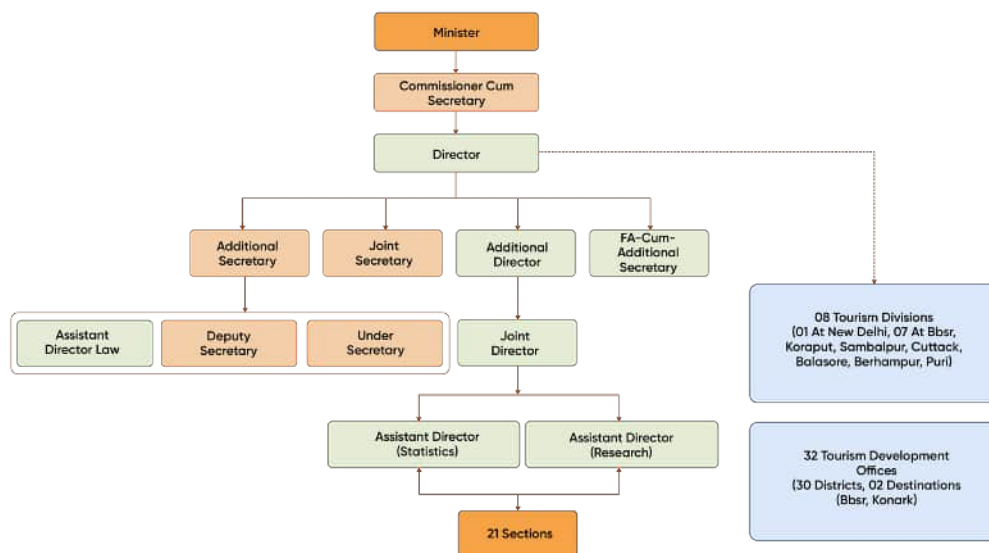
To accelerate tourism-led growth and align with the Vision Odisha 2036 and 2047, the Government has notified the Odisha Tourism (Amendment) Policy, 2026. The policy seeks to enhance ease of doing business, attract private investment, promote sustainable and experiential tourism, strengthen support for tourism entrepreneurs, and encourage the development of emerging segments such as MICE, destination weddings, heritage tourism, electric mobility, and Odia cuisine. With a target of creating approximately 15,000 star-category hotel rooms by 2036, the policy aims to generate large-scale employment and position Odisha as a leading tourism destination in India.

2. Organisation Details

Though started as a Public Relations activity and later as a part of former Home Department (PR), since 1960, Tourism became a regular function of the State Government with the creation of Tourism and Cultural Affairs Department in 13th of November 1973.

The Department, thus created, was subsequently renamed as Tourism, Sports & Culture Department in 10th of June 1980. In course of further re-organization of Departments, a separate Department was created for Tourism in 2nd of January 1991.

Subsequently, a new Department of Tourism & Culture was created on 30th December 1995. Again Tourism & Culture Department was separated on 6th March 2018 and now both departments function independently.



The Department of Tourism has a Composite office. Directorate of Tourism is a part of this Composite office with 08 Tourism Division Offices located at Puri, Bhubaneswar, Cuttack, Berhampur, Sambalpur, Balasore, Koraput and New Delhi along with 25 Tourism Development Offices located in different parts of the state such as Khordha, Nayagarh, Jajpur, Jagatsinghpur, Kendrapada, Bhadrak, Mayurbhanj (Baripada), Keonjhar, Sundargarh (Rourkela), Bargarh, Jharsuguda, Deogarh, Dhenkanal, Angul, Balangir, Sonepur, Kalahandi (Bhawanipatna), Nuapada, Rayagada, Malkangiri, Nabarangpur, Kandhamal (Phulbani), Boudh, Gajapati (Paralakhemundi) and Konark.

Besides, there is one Tourist Information Counter inside the State at the Biju Patnaik International Airport, Bhubaneswar.

3. Odisha Tourism Development Corporation Ltd (OTDC)

Tourism, constituted under Tourism Department Resolution No.3221/TSM, dated the 27th of February 1979 and it was incorporated under the Indian Companies Act, 1956 on the 03rd of September 1979.

OTDC is continuously promoting Tourism Activity and providing hospitality services in and outside Odisha for the last 44 years.

OTDC operates 14 hotels in the state, 15 no. of restaurants and cafeterias, has a fleet of 36 no. of vehicles for tours and transport services, 15 water transport fleet and a modern air ticketing unit.

OTDC also undertakes Engineering unit for execution of various tourism infrastructure projects.

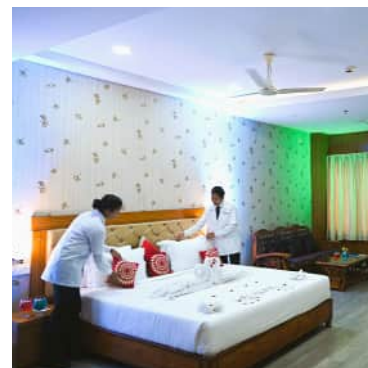


4 • State Institute Of Hotel Management (SIHM)

With an objective to spread and impart quality tourism education & skilling in the state, in 2004-05, the State Govt. has set up a Food Craft Institute at District Tourism Centre, Balangir as a joint venture scheme of Ministry of Tourism, Government of India. Subsequently the Institute was upgraded to State Institute of Hotel Management (SIHM), Balangir on 18th October 2010, affiliated to NCHMCT (National Council for Hotel Management & Catering Technology), Noida, U.P.-201301.

STREAMS AND COURSES OFFERED

Sl. No.	Name of the Course	Duration	Entry Level Qualification	Intake Capacity
1	B.Sc in Hospitality & Hotel Administration (Degree Program)	3 years	10+2 pass (Any stream)	60
2	Diploma in Food Production	1 & ½ year	10+2 pass (Any stream)	30
3	Diploma in Front Office Operation	1 & ½ year	10+2 pass (Any stream)	40
4	Diploma in Food & Beverage Service	1 & ½ year	10+2 pass (Any stream)	30
5	Diploma in Housekeeping Operation	1 & ½ year	10+2 pass (Any stream)	40
6	Diploma in Bakery & Confectionery	1 & ½ year	10+2 pass (Any stream)	30
7	Craftsmanship Certificate Course in Food Production & Patisserie	1 & ½ year	10+2 pass	30
8	Craftsmanship Certificate Course in Food & Beverage Service	6 months	10+2 pass	30



5. Objectives

The main objectives of the Department of Tourism are to increase tourist arrivals to the State, extend their duration of stay, create basic tourist infrastructure, promote and position Odisha as one of the preferred tourism destinations among domestic & international tourist markets.

To achieve the above objectives, Department of Tourism has adopted a multi-pronged strategy to promote tourism aggressively in the source markets.

6. Sector Development Strategy

It is a well-accepted fact that the tourism sector is basically government sector led and private sector driven industry where government acts as a catalyst and facilitator, formulates plans, policies and programmes for tourism development. The private sector plays a more proactive role where they invest money and get profit out of developed tourism ventures.

Department of Tourism, Govt. of Odisha has adopted a multi-pronged strategy for the sector promotion and development of tourism by creating requisite infrastructure and facilities within the State and organizes effective publicity and promotional campaigns within and outside the State. Department of Tourism, Govt. of Odisha is the nodal agency to formulate plan & policies for the development and promotion of Tourism.

In the process, the Department consults and collaborates with other stakeholders in the sector, including various line departments and trade representatives for balanced development of tourism. To promote balance development of tourism, infrastructure creation and to provide thrust to Tourism sector, a new Odisha Tourism Policy was launched in December 2022. The policy aims to create an ecosystem which will attract more investments through liberalized incentives and benefits.

Tourist Centre: A place that holds potential to attract tourists from outside is generally known as 'Tourist Centre'. As on March 2026, 382 places have been identified in the State as Tourist Centers. The infrastructure of tourism development falls into two categories, civic infrastructure and tourist infrastructure.

While road, electricity, water, external and internal transport, postal and telecommunication, medical care, etc. constitute civic infra; accommodation, restaurant, public convenience, organized & guided tours, recreation and guide services, etc. constitute tourist infra. Availability of civic facilities is a prerequisite for creation of tourist facilities.

With the creation of OTDC in 1979, the tourist facilities, like accommodation and transport, hitherto operated by the Department as promotional ventures, were entrusted to OTDC and commercial operations have begun from 1st September 1980 to operate on commercial basis.

The Department, however, continues to create and operate new tourist facilities for the benefit of tourists.

Tourism marketing and publicity is one of the major functions of the Department. The Department organizes fairs, festivals and special events directly and supports some tourism festivals organized by various stakeholders that lead to the promotion of tourism in state.

Attractive advertisements both in print and electronic media, advertisements using hoardings, in-flight magazines, trade journals etc. for promotion of tourism are regularly released. In addition, various theme-based documentary films on tourism are produced and broadcasted.

Under Hospitality schemes, the Department extends hospitality to Tour Operators, Travel Agents etc. via FAM trips to visit Odisha to get firsthand information and on return give wide publicity, which is much cheaper way of promoting a destination. Tourism stakeholders of the state are also supported financially to promote the state in various markets.

7. Highlights of the activities

Branding, Promotion and Publicity

Tourism branding, promotion, and publicity stand as pivotal functions within the realm of the Department, propelling the tourism industry of Odisha to greater heights. With an emphasis on comprehensive outreach, the Department orchestrates 360-degree communication strategies employing a myriad of platforms including Print, TV, Out-of- Home (OOH), social media, and Road shows. These multifaceted approaches ensure a holistic promotion that resonates with diverse audiences, both locally and globally. Moreover, the Department extends its hospitality through strategic initiatives such as Familiarization (FAM) trips tailored for Tour Operators and Travel Agents.

Outdoor Branding (OOH)

With a view to promote Odisha in the domestic market, Odisha Tourism undertook Out of Home (OOH) branding and promotions at the following airports:

- ▶ **Indira Gandhi International Airport, New Delhi**
- ▶ **Chhatrapati Shivaji International Airport, Mumbai**
- ▶ **Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose International Airport, Kolkata**
- ▶ **Kempegowda International Airport, Bengaluru**
- ▶ **Birsa Munda Airport, Ranchi**
- ▶ **Biju Patnaik International Airport, Bhubaneswar**
- ▶ **Lokpriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport, Guwahati**
- ▶ **Veer Surendra Sai Airport, Jharsuguda**
- ▶ **Visakhapatnam International Airport**
- ▶ **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel International Airport, Ahmedabad**
- ▶ **Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport, Varanasi**
- ▶ **Rajiv Gandhi International Airport , Hyderabad**
- ▶ **Chennai International Airport , Chennai**

- ▶ **Jay Prakash Narayan International Airport , Patna**
- ▶ **Pune Airport**
- ▶ **Swami Vivekananda Airport, Raipur**
- ▶ **Jaipur International Airport, Jaipur**
- ▶ **Goa –Dabolim Airport (older, military-civilian)**
- ▶ **Manohar International Airport (new one at Mopa)**
- ▶ **Cochin International Airport**

To promote Odisha branding at INOX and PVR multiplexes have been carried out during the screening of blockbuster movies .

Radio

Odisha Tourism ran radio campaign ads in target source markets of Odisha on FM channels as My FM, Radio City and Radio Mirchi.

Print Media

Advertisement is one of the powerful channels of communication to create public awareness. The Department of Tourism has brought out new campaigns in collaboration with various print media houses like Outlook, Taj Magazine , Hello 6E, Air India and Spice Jet to promote Eco Retreat and other tourism destinations of Odisha.

Digital Media

Odisha Tourism actively marketed various tourist destinations across digital channels to connect with its target audience. This involved placing digital advertisements in prominent English and regional news media platforms across India, including Hindustan Times, Zee News, Daily Hunt, Times Now & TOI, ABP News, Amar Ujala, Indian Express, TV 9, Madhyom, Dainik Jagran (Hindi), One India.Com. In addition to it, special promotions were carried out on platforms like IRCTC, Make My Trip, Google, Digital Cinema (INOX, PVR etc.) , IXIGO, Zepto, Inshorts and Phone Pe, Ease My Trip and Paytm to advertise Odisha Tourism products.

8. Odisha Tourism – Digital Initiatives

Special Media Campaigns

Due to the increasing impact of social media, Odisha Tourism enlisted influencers such as food bloggers, lifestyle bloggers and travel bloggers to endorse Odisha Tourism's festivals like Ratha Jatra Special Platter, Raja Mahotsav, 36 th Konark Festival, 15th International Sand Art Festival, Pakhala Dibasa 2026, Odisha Parab and more on their social media accounts.

Odisha Tourism presence on Social Media Platforms

Odisha Tourism maintains a strong presence on various social media platforms such as Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, YouTube, and more, consistently providing current updates on events, new initiatives, tourist destinations, and more. Annual calendar events like

Konark Festival, International Sand Art Festival are live streamed on the official social media handles. A special collaboration was done with X (formerly twitter) and Google to promote Eco Retreats of Odisha, temple & heritage monuments, waterfalls, water sports, cuisine and more.

Department of Tourism has undertaken several digital initiatives to enhance service delivery, improve tourist engagement, and promote the state's tourism offerings through advanced technology platforms.

The Odisha Tourism Portal is currently being revamped using modern technologies on the Liferay DXP platform, incorporating features such as user-generated content, customized tour packages, online registration for hotels and tour operators, AI-powered itinerary customization, and a 24x7 AI chatbot helpline to assist tourists.

The Book Odisha Portal (Website & Mobile Application) serves as an integrated platform for seamless online booking of accommodations, ticketing for events, heritage walks, tour packages, Eco Retreats, and other tourism-related services, thereby improving accessibility and convenience for visitors.

The Department has also introduced the Go Adventure Portal, which facilitates operators in obtaining licenses, setting up adventure tourism activities, and availing investment subsidies for various adventure tourism projects, thereby promoting safe and structured adventure tourism across Odisha.

Similarly, the Go Homestay Portal has been developed to support the establishment of new homestays, provide investment subsidies, and promote existing homestays across the state. The portal aims to strengthen community-based tourism by enabling local stakeholders to participate in tourism activities while offering authentic and immersive experiences to visitors.

Additionally, the Odisha Tourism Travel Scheme Management System supports efficient implementation and monitoring of schemes such as the Barishtha Nagarika Tirtha Yatra Yojana and the Shri Jagannath Darshan Yojana (SJDY), ensuring transparency and streamlined beneficiary management.

The Project Monitoring Information System (PMIS) is currently in its final stage of development and will enable effective tracking, monitoring, and management of tourism infrastructure and development projects across the state.

To strengthen digital outreach and promote tourism products holistically, Odisha Tourism actively engages influencers—including RJs, actors, actresses, and other celebrities—to showcase destinations across various social media platforms.

Odisha Tourism maintains a strong presence on social media platforms such as Facebook (279K followers), Twitter (1.1 million followers), Instagram (183K followers), and YouTube (81.8K subscribers). These platforms are regularly updated with information on tourism activities, festivals, schemes, policies, and new initiatives. Major annual events hosted by the Department are also live-streamed through official social media channels to maximize outreach.

Additionally, event-based pop-ups are strategically displayed on the website's landing pages to provide timely updates and highlight ongoing or upcoming tourism events and campaigns.

Digital Portals

1. Launch of the Go Adventure Portal, which has been made live for entrepreneurs and adventure tourism operators to establish and operate adventure tourism activities across the State.
2. Revamp of the Odisha Tourism official website, Book Odisha portal and mobile application, aimed at improving user experience, accessibility, and alignment with current digital standards.
3. Boat bookings at Satapada were made live on the Odisha Yatri platform, enabling visitors and citizens to book boats online.
4. Go Homestay Portal is currently under development to streamline the entire homestay application process and incorporate a visitor management module and will be integrated with the official DoT website while being provided free of cost to all eligible homestay owners under the scheme.

Shri Jagannath Darshan Yojana (SJDY) Portal has been made live, and applications are being submitted through a dedicated Travel Management Portal, through which the Department is tracking trip schedules, beneficiary data, and feedback, and monitoring grievances via the portal.

9. Tourism Events & Trade Fairs

To promote the State's tourism products and packages, DoT explores various opportunities in the tourism & hospitality sector across identified source markets along with different stakeholders. Department of Tourism provides a platform where stakeholders of the State participate as co-exhibitors and promote the state. During 2025-26, Odisha Tourism along with key tourism stakeholders from the State participated in the following events:

INSIDE THE COUNTRY

Sl. No.	Name of the Event	Date
1	GITB Jaipur	4 th – 6 th May 2025
2	TTF, Kolkata	10 th –12 th July 2025
3	IITM, Chennai	16 th –18 th July 2025
4	IITM, Bengaluru	24 th –26 th July 2025
5	TTF, Ahmedabad	31 st July– 2 nd August 2025
6	BLTM, Delhi	11 th –13 th September 2025
7	IITM, Pune	27 th –29 th November 2025
8	IITM, Hyderabad	4 th – 6 th December 2025
9	IITM, Kochi	8 th – 10 th January 2026
10	OTM, Mumbai	5 th – 7 th February 2026
11	SATTE, Delhi	25 th – 27 th February 2026

Annual Events

Tourism branding, promotion, and publicity stand as pivotal functions with an emphasis on comprehensive outreach, the Department orchestrates 360-degree communication strategies employing a myriad of platforms including Print, TV, Out-of- Home (OOH), social media, and Road shows.

a. ATM Dubai

The Department of Tourism, Government of Odisha, made a notable mark at the 32nd edition of the Arabian Travel Market (ATM) 2025, held from April 28 to May 1 at the Dubai World Trade Centre. Leveraging the global platform, Odisha strategically positioned itself as a vibrant and multi-faceted destination, capturing the imagination of global travel professionals. The Odisha Pavilion drew significant attention, facilitating nearly 300 Government-to-Business (G2B) meetings and drawing widespread attention from stakeholders across the Middle East, Southeast Asia, and Europe. The State's diverse tourism portfolio—spanning Monsoon Tourism, Eco Retreats, Nature Trails, Coastal Experiences, and MICE (Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions)—were prominently featured.

b. GITB Jaipur

At GITB 2025, Odisha Tourism conducted over 230 B2B and G2B meetings with leading Foreign Tour Operators (FTOs) and Destination Management Companies (DMCs) from 16+ countries. The Odisha Pavilion was awarded Best Stall – Public Sector Category, recognising its immersive AR/VR experience and curated cultural showcase. High-level engagements with platforms like Yatra and Sita Travels, and operators from Australia, Serbia, and Romania, generated strong interest in Odisha's spiritual, Eco, and MICE tourism offerings. The State extended invitations for Odisha Travel Bazaar 2026, with planned FAM trips to Raghurajpur, Pipili, Satkosia, and Bhitarkanika. The delegation was led by Hon'ble DCM Smt. Pravati Parida at Jaipur. At the event, Odisha's single-window facilitation model, diverse circuits, and improved air connectivity received positive response from industry leaders and policy makers alike.



c. Traditional Boat Races (Mahanadi & Chilika)

To revive and promote Odisha's rich maritime and riverine heritage, the Department of Tourism supported the organisation of traditional boat races as flagship cultural-tourism events. The Mahanadi Boat Race was organised for the first time at the national level, witnessing participation from 15 teams representing different states across India. The event drew significant public interest and media attention, reinforcing Odisha's legacy of river-based traditions historically associated with festivals such as Bali Jatra.

In addition, the Chilika Lake Boat Race witnessed enthusiastic participation from the local fishing community, with more than 700 fishermen and boatmen taking part in the event, showcasing Odisha's vibrant living traditions and community-driven maritime heritage.

These initiatives aim to position Odisha as a destination for heritage-based and water-centric tourism, while creating livelihood opportunities for local communities, strengthening cultural identity, and expanding the State's tourism calendar with distinctive, high-impact events.

d. Guru Padmasambhava Ceremony

The Guru Padmasambhava Ceremony was organised from 11 to 16 January 2026, commemorating the legacy and teachings of Guru Padmasambhava, a revered figure in Vajrayana Buddhism. The ceremony witnessed the participation of over 1,500 monks from South Asian countries, reflecting the event's international spiritual significance and reinforcing Odisha's role as an important centre of Buddhist heritage and cultural exchange.

e. 6th Chilika Bird Festival

The 6th Chilika Bird Festival was organised from 6 to 8 January 2026, celebrating the lagoon's rich biodiversity and its importance as a global habitat for migratory birds. The festival attracted birdwatchers, nature enthusiasts, conservationists, and photographers from across the country, promoting eco-tourism while highlighting conservation awareness and sustainable tourism practices in and around Chilika.



f. Flagship Event – Eco Retreat 2025

To establish Odisha as a premier adventure tourism destination by leveraging its diverse natural landscapes, promoting sustainable and safe adventure experiences, and fostering economic growth through structured development, innovation, and responsible tourism practices.



g. Odisha Parab

Odisha Parab is a flagship cultural outreach initiative that celebrates and showcases the rich heritage, vibrant traditions, diverse tourism offerings and economic potential of Odisha on a national platform. Through a curated blend of cultural performances, handicrafts exhibitions, culinary experiences, tourism promotion and stakeholder engagement, the event strengthens cultural connections with the Odia diaspora while introducing wider audiences to the State's unique identity. The first three editions were successfully held in Bengaluru, Guwahati and Ahmedabad, expanding the State's cultural footprint across key cities. Odisha Parab also serves as a strategic platform to promote local artisans, women-led enterprises and emerging sectors, reinforcing Odisha's commitment to inclusive growth, cultural preservation and soft power outreach.



h. 36th Konark Festival

The 36th Konark Festival celebrated Odisha's rich legacy of classical dance, music and cultural excellence against the iconic backdrop of the Sun Temple, reinforcing the State's position as a global hub of heritage tourism. The festival brought together renowned and emerging artists from across India, offering captivating performances in Odissi and other classical traditions while attracting tourists, cultural enthusiasts and international visitors. Beyond artistic celebration, the event contributed to destination promotion, local economic activity and the preservation of intangible cultural heritage, reflecting Odisha's continued commitment to showcasing its timeless traditions on a prestigious cultural platform.



i. 15th International SandArt Festival

The 15th International Sand Art Festival showcased Odisha's unique coastal heritage and artistic excellence, bringing together acclaimed sand artists from India and across the globe at Chandrabhaga Beach, Konark. The festival featured intricate sand sculptures centered on themes of culture, environment, and social awareness, drawing large numbers of tourists, art enthusiasts and media attention. By promoting creative expression alongside tourism, the event strengthened Odisha's global cultural presence, supported local livelihoods, and reinforced the State's commitment to fostering art, sustainability and destination branding.

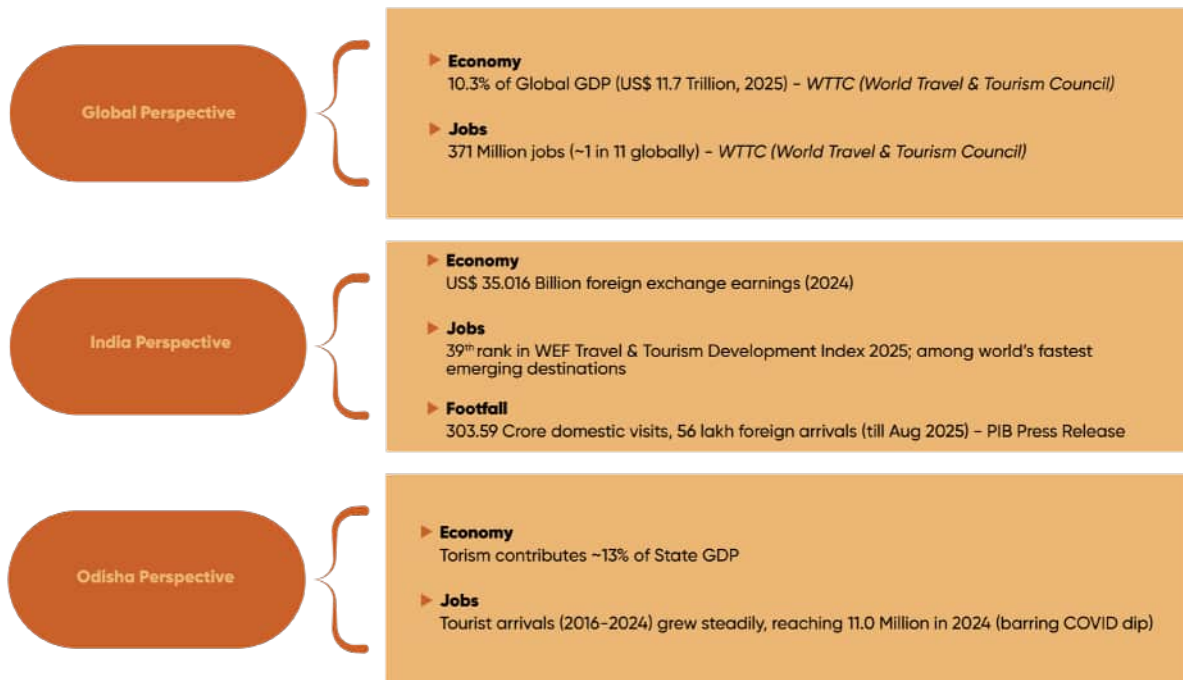


j. Pakhala Paraba

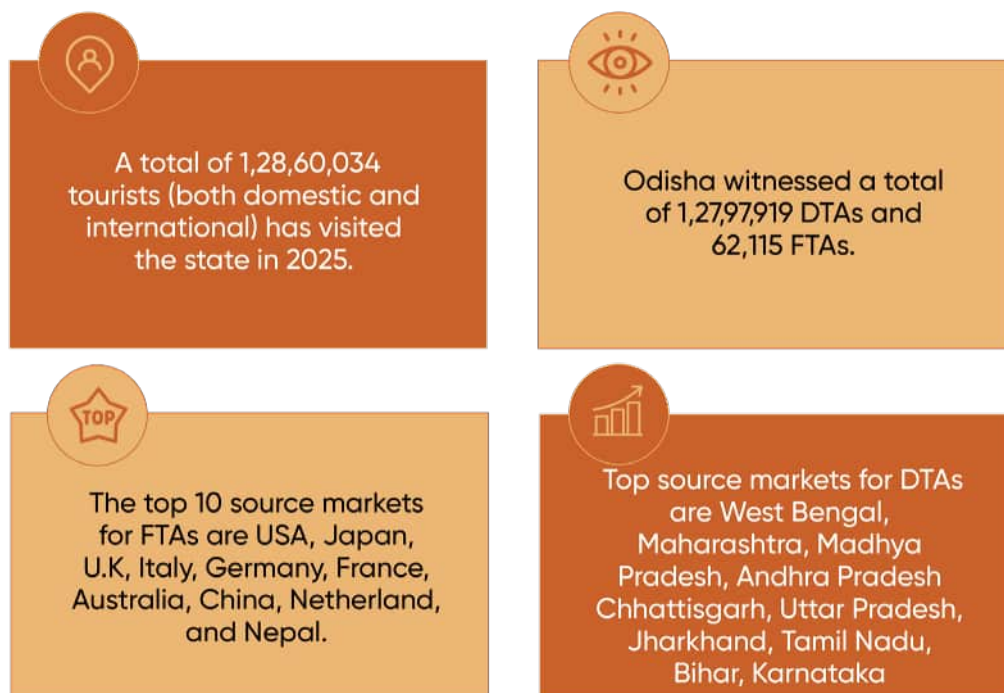
Pakhala Paraba emerged as a grand celebration of Odisha's culinary heritage, bringing together culture, tradition, and community spirit on a remarkable scale. The event witnessed the esteemed presence of the Hon'ble Chief Minister and Hon'ble Deputy Chief Minister of Odisha, underscoring the State Government's commitment to promoting Odisha's rich gastronomic identity on national and global platforms. At the heart of the celebration was the creation of a Guinness World Record with the preparation of an extraordinary 1,174 kg serving of Pakhala, symbolising both cultural pride and collective participation. The event transformed a humble traditional dish into a powerful cultural statement, showcasing Pakhala not merely as food, but as an enduring symbol of Odisha's agrarian legacy, sustainable lifestyle, and timeless culinary traditions.



10. Tourism Sector Overview

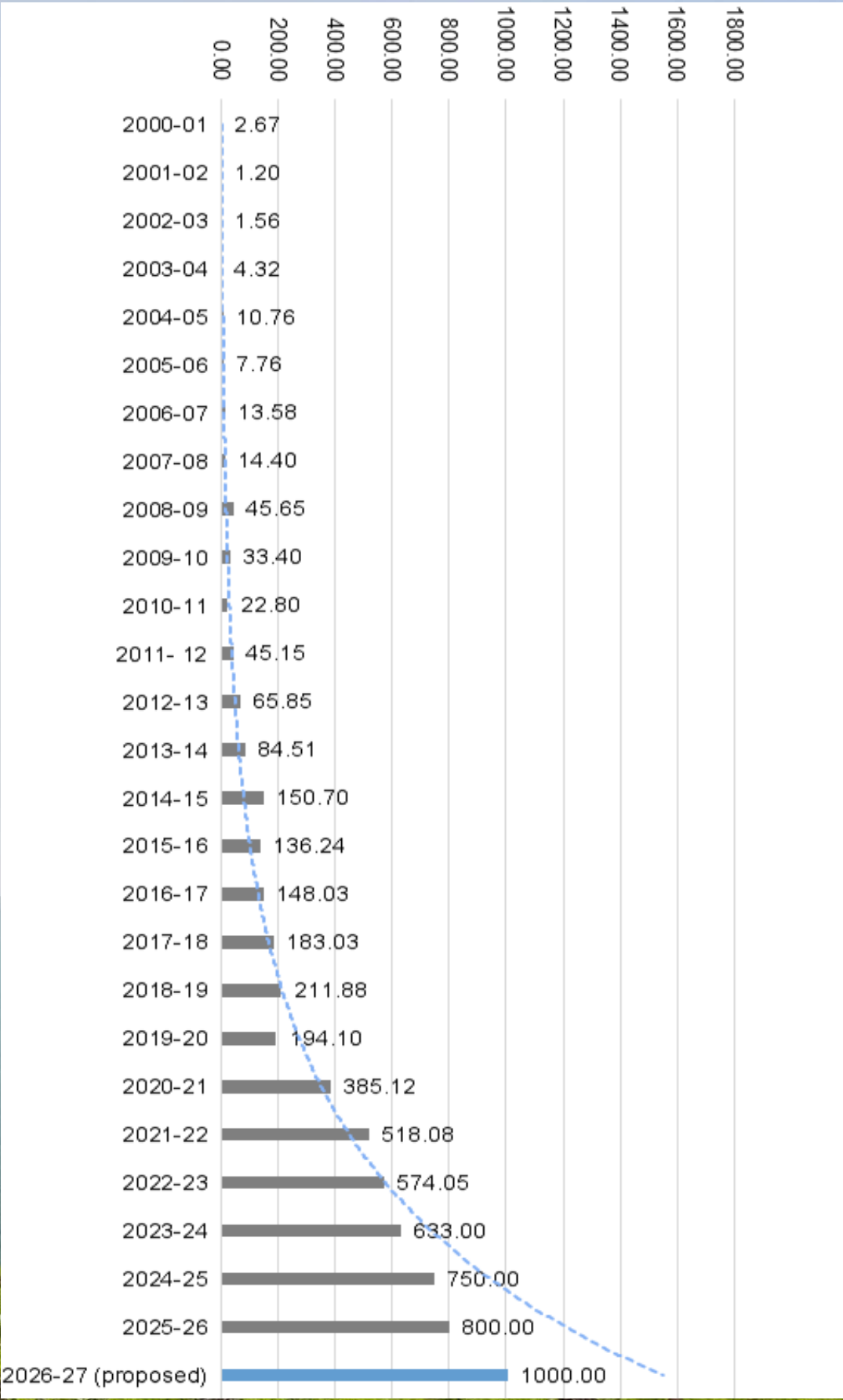


10.1 Tourism Trends In Odisha



Deomali...

11. Tourism Budget Overview



Approved Outlay and Expenditure (INR in LAKHS)

Name of the Scheme (2021-27)	2021-22		2022-23		2023-24		2024-25		2025-26		2026-27
	Outlay	Expendi- ture	Outlay	Expendi- ture	Outlay	Expendi- ture	Outlay	Expen- diture	Outlay	Expen- diture	Outlay
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
102- Tourist Accommoda- tion	3485999	3485999	27545	27545	35016	35015.93	23128	23128	21702	21702	21202
796-TASP	-	-	-	-	-	-	6700	6700	8164	8164	7964
789-SCSP	-	-	-	-	-	-	4300	4300	6034	6034	5834
Sub-Total	34860	34860	27545	27545	35016	35015.93	34128	34128	35900	35900	50000
104-Promotion and Publicity	13440.01	1343998	25999.7	24999.69	36235	36234.9	35847	-	41238	41237	44500
C.P (PRASAD)	3508	-	3858.8		4000	-	5000	-	5500	--	5500
Total	51808	48300	57403.5	52544.7	75251	71250.8	74975	34128	82638	77137	100000

Programme Expenditure Budget Provision Of Tourism Department For The Year 2025-26 (INR In Lakhs)

Sl No.	Name of the Scheme./ Sub scheme	Head of Account	Budget provision
1	DEVELOPMENT AND MANAGEMENT OF TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE	32-5452- CAPITAL OUT LAY ON TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-01- TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE-102- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION-1468- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION -37078-CONSTRUCTION OF TOURIST ACCOMMODATION -073-Infrastructural Assets (voted)-2025-26	21301.99
2	DEVELOPMENT AND MANAGEMENT OF TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE- TRIBAL AREA SUB PLAN	32-5452- CAPITAL OUT LAY ON TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-01- TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE-796- TRIBAL AREA SUB PLAN -1468- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION -37078-CONSTRUCTION OF TOURIST ACCOMMODATION -073-Infrastructural Assets (voted)-2025-26	8164
3	DEVELOPMENT AND MANAGEMENT OF TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE- SPECIAL COMPONENT PLAN FOR SCHEDULED CASTE	32-5452- CAPITAL OUT LAY ON TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-01- TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE-789-SPECIAL COMPONENT PLAN FOR SCHEDULED CASTE-1468- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION -37078-CONSTRUCTION OF TOURIST ACCOMMODATION -073-Infrastructural Assets (voted)-2025-26	6034
4	INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY INFRASTRUCTURE AND E-GOVERNANCE	32-5452- CAPITAL OUT LAY ON TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-01- TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE-102- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION-1468- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION -78245- INFORMATION AND TECHENLOGY INFRASTRUCTURE-073-Infrastructural Assets (voted)-2025-26.	400
5	SIDIB CLUSTER DEVELOPMENT FUND	32-5452- CAPITAL OUT LAY ON TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-01- TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE-102- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION-3566-SIDBI CLUSTER EDEVELOPMENT FUND(SCDF) -20002-OTHER CHARGES -073-Infrastructural Assets (voted)-2025-26	0.01
		TOTAL (CAPITAL EXPENDITURE)	35900
6	PUBLICITY OF TOURISM	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-TOURIST INFORMATION AND PUBLICITY-11005- ADVERTISING SALES AND PUBLICITY-026-Advertisement and Publicity (voted)	17781.98
7	NEW TOURISM POLICY AND CRITICAL GAP FUNDING	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-78662 NEW TOURISM POLICY AND CRITICAL GAP FUNDING-049-other Revenue expenditure (voted)2025-26.	7000
8	SAFETY SECURITY AND SANITATION	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-78661 safety security and sanitation -049-other Revenue expenditure (voted)2025-26.	5000
9	Shree Jagannath Darshan Yojana	32-3452-TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-3497-SHREE JAGANNATH Darshan Yojana-20002-OTHER CHARGES-049-Other Revenue Expenditure (voted). 2025-26	700

10	UPGRADATION AND RENOVATION OF TOURISM PROPERTY	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-TOURIST INFORMATION AND PUBLICITY-22079-Up-gradation and Renovation of Tourism property-049-other Revenue expenditure (voted)2025-26.	7098
11	BARISTHA NAGARIKA TIRTHA YATRA YOJANA	32-3452-TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-3117-BARISTA NAGARIKA TIRTHA YATRA YOJANA-20002-OTHER CHARGES-049-Other Revenue Expenditure (voted). 2025-26	239999
12	GRANTS TO STATE INSTITUTE OF HOTEL MANAGEMENT BOL-ANGIR.	32-3452-TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-796- TRIBAL AREA SUB PLAN -1470-TOURIST INFORMATION AND PUBLICITY -41093-GRANT IN AID TO FOOD CRAFT INSTITUTE BOLANGIR (voted). 2025-26.	436
		031-Grant in Aid GENERAL - Rs.61,00,000	
		036--Grant in Aid(Salaries)- Rs.3,75,00,000/-	
13	Tourism –TRAIN-ING AND CAPACITY BUILDING	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-TOURIST INFORMATION AND PUBLICITY -78514-TRAINING PROGRAMME FOR CAPACITY BUILDING-009-Training Expenses(voted0-2025-26	142
14	INFORMATION ,EDUCATION AND COMMUNICATION ACTIVITIES	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-0708-Information, Education and Communication-78159- Information, Education and Communication Activities-026-Advertisement & publicity.(Vot-ed)-2025-26	200
15	EXPOSURE VISIT TO SINGAPORE AND DUBAI	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-TOURIST INFORMATION AND PUBLICITY -18013-EXPOSURE VISIT-049-Other Revenue Expenditure (voted).2025-26	200
16	Odisha Home-stay Establishment Scheme 2020	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-TOURIST INFORMATION AND PUBLICITY-28038-ODISHA HOMESTAY ESTABLISHMENT-049-other Revenue expenditure (voted)2025-26.	280.01
17	Scheme for Up-gra-dation of traditional/ wooden Tourist-car-rying boats used in various water bodies in Odisha	32-3452- TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE-STATE SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR-80-GENERAL-104-PROMOTION AND PUBLICITY-1470-TOURIST INFORMATION AND PUBLICITY-22078-UP-GRADATION OF TRADITIONAL TOURIST BOATS	0.01
		TOTAL (REVENUE EXPENDITURE)	41237.99
	TOTAL STATE PLAN		77137.99
18	PILGRIMAGE REJUVENATION AND SPIRITUAL AUGMENTATION DRIVE(PRASA-D)-CENTRAL SEC-TOR SCHEME	32-5452- CAPITAL OUT LAY ON TOURISM-PROGRAMME EXPENDI-TURE-CENTRAL SECTOR SCHEMES-STATE SECTOR -01- TOURIST INFRASTRUCTURE-102- TOURIST ACCOMMODATION-1468-37078- CONSTRUCTION OF TOURIST ACCOMMMODATION -073-Infrastruc-tural Assets (voted)-2025-26 .	5500
		TOTAL PROGRAMME EXPENDITURE BUDGET	82637.99

12. Major Actions/ Activities

12.1 Viksit Odisha 2036-47

The Department of Tourism has undertaken comprehensive strategic planning in alignment with Viksit Odisha Vision 2036–2047, with clearly defined outcome-oriented KPIs structured around four core pillars: destination development and management, investment promotion, capacity building and skill development, and marketing, branding, promotion, and digital initiatives. These pillars collectively guide tourism growth while ensuring sustainability, inclusivity, and competitiveness.

Key Outputs of Vision KPIs of Tourism Department was prepared based with 4 key initiatives such as

- i. Destination Development & Management,
- ii. Investment Promotion
- iii. Capacity Building & Skill Development
- iv. Marketing, Branding, Promotion & Digital Initiatives

12.1.1 Major Recommendations

- a) Promote niche tourism offerings such as eco-retreats and similar nature-centric experiences that align with Odisha's ecological and cultural landscape.
- b) Focus on the development of water-based and adventure tourism activities, with tourism products defined by forest and hill terrains to create location-specific offerings.
- c) Enhance the overall tourist experience by developing strategic tourism nodes and involving institutions such as Ward-level Area Committees (WACs) and Mission Shakti groups in planning and operations.
- d) Optimise tourism asset utilisation through improved monetisation strategies, including leasing and Public-Private Partnership (PPP) models, based on asset viability.
- e) In cases where leasing is not feasible, ensure that the upgradation of tourism assets is carried out to unmatched standards of quality and sustainability.
- f) Strengthen the existing tourism workforce through upskilling, quality improvement, and capacity enhancement. Focus on guest etiquette training, onboarding of new talent, contractual engagement, and inclusion of trained youth.
- g) Address the overconcentration of hospitality services in Bhubaneswar and Puri by promoting regional hospitality growth and strengthening land banks in strategic areas such as forest zones and Hirakud.

- h) Implement community-based tourism projects in locations where private investment is lacking, particularly leveraging the state's forest resources. The Department of Tourism, in collaboration with consultants, can plan and develop adventure parks, tourist villages, and wellness centres.
- i) Establish caravan parks in offbeat and remote locations with limited accommodation infrastructure, which can be operated through OTDC or PPP frameworks to enhance accessibility and experience.
- j) Upgrade tourism collaterals and marketing materials, including new video content and the adoption of advanced technologies such as AR/VR. All promotional materials should be multilingual to cater to diverse audiences.
- k) Participate actively in tourism events and expos in a planned and strategic manner to showcase Odisha's tourism assets and enable deeper penetration into source markets.
- l) Promote technology-enabled services through the development and maintenance of booking portals and comprehensive grievance or complaint management systems, with facilitation by OTDC.
- m) Facilitate tourism investment through dedicated promotion activities and provide structured handholding support for interested investors and entrepreneurs.
- n) Introduce and promote curated cuisine tours that highlight the culinary heritage and diversity of Odisha as a key tourism attraction.
- o) Appoint a suitable brand ambassador to represent the Department of Tourism and effectively position Odisha in national and international tourism markets through innovative campaigns.
- p) Curate a vibrant annual event calendar under the Department of Tourism's budget, featuring events such as hot air balloon festivals, boat races, and marathons to attract sustained tourist interest.
- q) Address infrastructure gaps through a continuous and careful development approach that ensures the provision of essential amenities such as PCC roads, drinking water, parking facilities, illumination, sanitation, and safety infrastructure, aligned with the State Tourism Policy.



12.1.2 Short term initiatives and goals

Sl.	Outcome Area	Short-Term (till 2029)	FY 2025-26	FY 2026-27	FY 2027-28	FY 2028-29	Remarks
1	Premium Keys (Hotels)	Fast-track PPP projects, expand resorts at priority sites (5,000 no.)	3100	3647	4294	5146	Odisha Tourism (Amendment) Policy, 2026 provides unmatched incentives & development of land bank
2	Total Tourist Footfall	Double footfall via campaigns & branding (Cr.)	1.10	1.30	1.64	2.04	Introduction of Niche Tourism Products like Caravan & focus on promotional events such as boat race, skydiving, Marathon, aggressive digital mktg. etc.
3	Foreign Tourist Footfall	Boost via charter flights, visa facilitation, global roadshows (1,56,000)	53,000	74,200	1,07,590	1,56,006	Proposed enhanced international air connectivity, promotion in global source markets
4	Destination Mgmt. Companies (DMCs)	Incentivize new inbound DMCs (14 nos.)	2	4	8	16	Incentive packages for bringing larger DMCs to Odisha
5	Tour Operators	Train & certify operators; push digital adoption (100 nos.)	37	44	62	99	Stipend based incentives mechanism for youths to become tour operator & relaxed conditions to become tour operators
6	State Tourist Guides	Deployment of Tourist guides through Paryatan Mitra Initiative Train multilingual, certified guides (900 nos.)	373	466	629	913	Concentrated shall be efforts shall be undertaken for skilling of tourism workforce especially youths residing near prominent tourism destination through IITM, SIHM, Paryatan mitra initiatives & tie ups with hospitality brands
7	Ecotourism Guides	Train eco-guides in key reserves & eco-sites (650 nos.)	200	260	377	603	

12.2 Budget Announcement 2025 – 26 vs Actions Taken

A. Hirakud and Satkosia under the SASCI Scheme during 2024-25

- i. Hirakud (Partial) and Satkosia projects approved under SASCI scheme for INR 99.90 Cr and INR 99.99 Cr respectively
- ii. Hirakud – Execution initiated by OCC
- iii. Satkosia – Execution initiated by DoFE&CC

B. Implementation of the Odisha New Destination Policy-2024

- i. Part of C&T Dept

C. Heritage Craft and Weavers Villages of National Importance

- i. Execution initiated for craft villages at Kotpad (Koraput), Singpalli (Bargarh), and Kardola (Sambalpur), Guhaldihi (Mayurbhanj) and Raghurajpur (Puri). Few other craft villages are taken up by HTH Dept.

D. Western Odisha – Hirakud STZ

- i. Draft Act for Special Tourism Zone prepared and sent to Law Dept.
- ii. Interim multi-stakeholder committee formed under the Chairmanship of the RDC (Northern Division) until the SPV – Hirakud Dam Area Tourism Development Authority (HDATDA) is constituted.
- iii. Draft HDATDA (Hirakud Dam Area Tourism Development Authority) demarcated in consultation with Collectors Sambalpur, Bargarh and Jharsuguda. Approval required.
- iv. SASCI components – Tree enumeration and demarcation at site completed. Tree felling and DoWR – Approval awaited for initiating execution
- v. State funded components – Architect onboarded by OTDC and execution to be initiated in Feb 2026

E. Buddhist Circuit

- i. OBCC has been entrusted for preparation of integrated masterplan for Buddhist circuit
- ii. Asian Development Bank in process of preparation of Strategy for development of Buddhist circuit in Odisha
- iii. MoU was signed with LBDFI to activate the Buddhist Circuit through annual Padmasambhava programs, pilgrim facilities, a research and visitor centre, and heritage promotion with linkages to Bodhgaya and Nalanda.
- iv. 3-month events proposed to activate Buddhist sites and Guru Padmasambhava Blessing Ceremony proposed in Jan 2026 jointly with LBDFI – Activation during tourism season.

F. Iconic destinations

- i. Deomali, Dhauli, Khandagiri-Udayagiri: Integrated masterplans preparation in progress by OTDC.
- ii. Chilika – CDA to take up development.
- iii. Khiching – OBCC entrusted for development – DPR Submitted to GoI for central funds.
- iv. Satkosia – Approved under SASCI Scheme (Taken up by DoFE&CC). DFO has submitted DPR to DoT for approval of components worth INR 99.90 Cr
- v. Similipal – Taken up by DoFE&CC as requested by DoT

G. Development and renovation of unidentified tourist centres

- i. A total of ~650 proposals for development of unidentified tourist centres across 26 districts have been received from Collectors and Public Representatives for consideration by the Department of Tourism

H. Beaches Development

- i. Beaches proposed to be developed – Talsari (Works Dept), Chandrabhaga (under execution by Works Dept), Gopalpur (BeDA), Chandipur (Works Dept), Paradeep (Odisha Police Housing), Shree Beach Puri (OMC). Astaranga Beach (DFO), Beleswar(DFO), Phulpatna (DFO), Pentha beach (DFO), Kasafal Beach (DFO), Biju Pattnaik Beach (to be decided)

I. Odisha Adventure Tourism Guideline 2025

- i. 19 nos. project Applications received on Go-Adventure portal for water-based adventure activities.
- ii. Preliminary scrutiny done by NIWS and ATTC meeting held for scrutiny of applications received.
- iii. Field scrutiny of 19 project applications ongoing by NIWS expert.

J. District Museums and Heritage Conservation

- i. Proposed locations for District Museums – Koraput, Bird museum- Chilika, Deogarh, Jajpur, (OLLIC to update regarding more museums taken up)
- ii. Proposed locations for Heritage conservation – Potagarh Fort, Ganjam; BN Palace, Paralakhemundi; Raja Bhakri, Sambalpur; Jubilee Library, Mayurbhanj
- iii. MoU signed with NCSM for museums at Make in Odisha Conclave 2025 for curation of museums
- iv. MoU signed with IIT Madras for heritage conservation for structural audit of heritage properties
- v. Conservation of heritage structures proposed (IIT Madras and INTACH)

K. Ecotourism Destinations: Modern and Eco-friendly amenities will be developed

- i. Satkosia – DFO has submitted DPR to DoT for approval of components worth INR 99.90 Cr
- ii. Simlipal – DFO has selected Architect for preparation of DPR (Kalikaprasad gate, Pithabata gate, Talabandha gate). Revision of masterplan in progress.
- iii. Chilika – Communication sent to CE CDA for development
- iv. Bhitarkanika – DFO has selected Architect for preparation of revised DPR (Dangamal, Gupti, Khola and Pentha) and other proposals by IWAI, IWT etc for water related infrastructure
- v. Mahendragiri – DFO has selected Architect for preparation of DPR.

L. Chilika – Special Tourism Zone

- i. Integrated Masterplan preparation – Communication sent to CE CDA for development
- ii. Bird museum – Conceptualised by DoT. Land identification at Mangalajodi completed and R&B to submit DPR for the same soon.
- iii. Eco friendly tourist boats- EV Boats financial affordability and capability workout in progress
- iv. Draft Act to be initiated

M. Shree Jagannath Darshan Yojana

- i. Scheme Guidelines notified. Scheme to be formally flagged off by Hon'ble CM in January-26

N. Integrated periphery development of Sakhi Gopinath Temple at Sakhigopal, Puri

- i. Hon'ble CM has approved the masterplan. OBCC has been entrusted for the project.

O. Paryatan Mitra Initiative (including Women Paryatan Mitra)

- i. Discussion held at CS Level. Yet to be finalised

P. Odisha Parab

- i. Odisha Parab, a flagship initiative of Department of Tourism was successfully organised in Bengaluru, Guwahati and Ahmedabad during 2025–26, receiving an overwhelming response from visitors.



12.3 Policy, Guidelines & Schemes

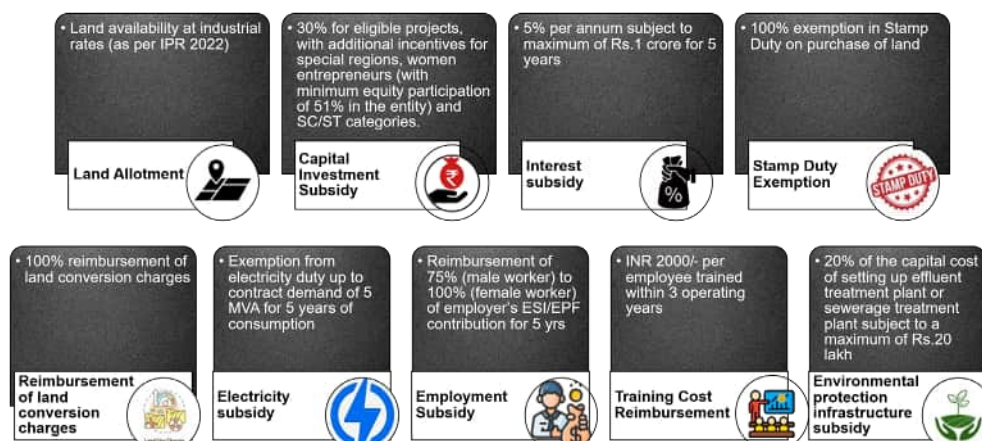
12.3.1 Odisha Tourism Policy 2022 and Amendment 2026

Odisha Tourism Policy 2022

Through this policy, the Department of Tourism (DoT) facilitated:

- Private sector investments through attractive financial and non-financial incentives
- Creation of a land bank by IDCO in tourism-potential areas
- Human resource development through capacity building and stakeholder sensitisation
- Strengthening of OTDC as an effective institution for tourism development, operation, and marketing
- Incentives for new tourism units and expansion of existing units

To attract private investment, the policy provides a comprehensive incentive package, including:



Odisha Tourism (Amendment) Policy - 2026

To further strengthen the policy ecosystem, the Odisha Tourism (Amendment) Policy, 2026 has been finalised and approved. The policy significantly liberalises entry barriers by reducing minimum room requirements for hotels and easing expansion norms, thereby encouraging small and medium investors. Capital Investment Subsidy (CIS) slabs have been rationalised with higher ceilings and enhanced incentives for special zones, priority tourism assets, and women, SC, ST, and differently abled entrepreneurs. The expansion of Special Tourism Zones and the proposal to constitute a State Tourism Advisory Council under the Chairmanship of the Hon'ble Minister of Tourism reflect a strong focus on institutional strengthening and decentralised governance.

- i. The policy streamlines eligibility by reducing the minimum room requirement for 3-Star and above hotels from 50 to 10 keys and easing expansion norms from 50% to 25%
- ii. CIS slabs rationalised: 30% subsidy with ceilings of Rs50 Cr (up to Rs200 Cr investment) and Rs 100 Cr (above Rs200 Cr). Enhanced CIS in Special Zones at 40% with ceilings of Rs60 Cr (up to Rs200 Cr) and Rs120 Cr (above Rs200 Cr). Enhanced incentives (up to 40%) for Women, SC, ST and Differently Abled entrepreneurs
- iii. Special Zones expanded to Hirkud, Satkosia, Similipal, Ratnagiri–Udayagiri–Lalitgiri and Bhitarkanika, in addition to Chilika, KBK, Kandhamal and Gajapati.
- iv. Higher CIS for priority assets: museums and heritage properties (40%), electric boats, electric caravans, and art & craft theme complexes (50%)- ceilings of Rs60 Cr (up to Rs200 Cr) and Rs120 Cr (above Rs200 Cr).
- v. Targeted incentives for Odia Cuisine restaurants, MICE and destination weddings, Revised fiscal support of up to INR 3.5 Lakh per event to Tourism Service Providers for overseas events and up to INR 50,000 per event to Homestay owners for domestic tourism events.
- vi. State Tourism Advisory Council proposed for institutional strengthening under chairmanship of Minister Tourism

12.3.2

Odisha Homestay Establishment Scheme-2025

The State Government has introduced the Odisha Homestay Establishment Scheme-2025 as a key initiative to diversify accommodation options, strengthen community participation, and ensure equitable distribution of tourism benefits across the State. Aligned with Vision 2036 and Vision 2047, the Scheme is expected to play a pivotal role in advancing Odisha's tourism development objectives by promoting local livelihoods and authentic visitor experiences.

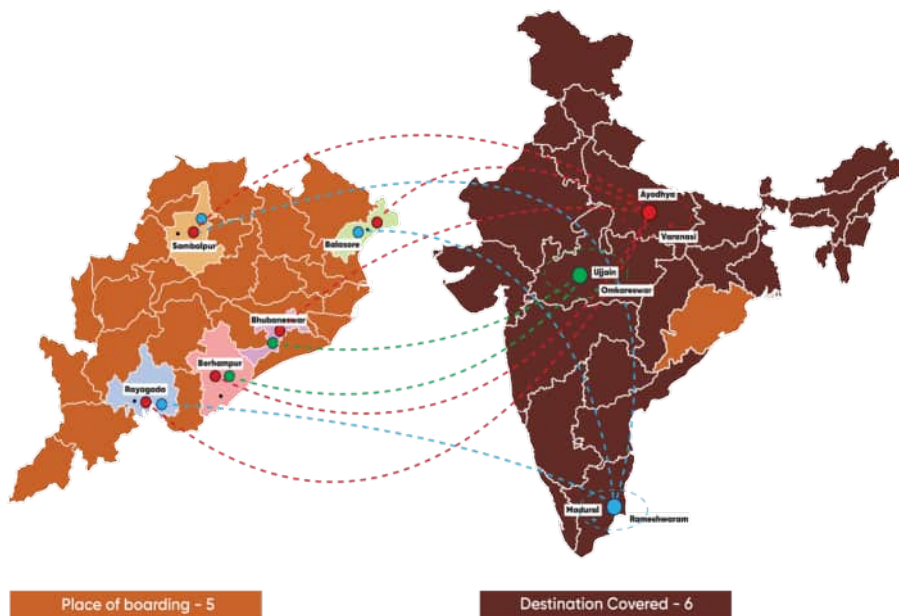
The scheme will result in new construction of ~450 nos. homestays (~1800 keys) in the state.





12.3.3 BNTYY (Baristha Nagarika Tirtha Yatra Yojana)

The Baristha Nagarika Tirtha Yatra Yojana (BNTYY) is a flagship initiative of the State Government aimed at enabling poor and deprived senior citizens aged 60–75 years to fulfil their long-cherished aspiration of undertaking pilgrimage with Government support. Implemented by the Tourism Department in collaboration with IRCTC, the scheme facilitates safe and organised pilgrimage journeys to important religious destinations across the country, with provisions for escort and medical support, thereby promoting inclusive, dignified, and spiritually enriching travel for senior citizens of the State.



Sl. No	Originating Station	Districts from which Pilgrims Travelled	No. of Pilgrims (including escort officers)	Trip Dates	Destination
1	Bhubaneswar (6 Districts)	Khoradha, Puri, Cuttack, Jagatsinghpur, Kendrapara, Dhenkanal	800	10.09.2025 to 17.09.2025	Ayodhya - Varanasi
2	Brahmapur (5 Districts)	Ganjam, Gajapati, Kandhamal, Nayagarh, Boudh	794	19.09.2025 to 24.09.2025	Ayodhya - Varanasi
3	Sambalpur (8 Districts)	Sambalpur, Sundargarh, Balangir, Baragarh, Jharsuguda, Deogarh, Angul, Subarnapur	800	08.10.2025 to 13.10.2025	Ayodhya - Varanasi
4	Rayagada (6 Districts)	Rayagada, Koraput, Malkangiri, Nabarangpur, Kalahandi, Nuapada	800	17.01.2026 to 22.01.2026	Ayodhya - Varanasi
5	Baleshwar (5 Districts)	Baleshwar, Mayurbhanj, Kendujhar, Jajpur, Bhadrak	800	07.11.2025 to 12.11.2025	Ayodhya - Varanasi
6	Brahmapur (5 Districts)	Ganjam, Gajapati, Kandhamal, Nayagarh, Boudh	800	17.11.2025 to 22.11.2025	Ujjain- Omkareshwar
7	Bhubaneswar (6 Districts)	Khoradha, Puri, Cuttack, Jagatsinghpur, Kendrapara, Dhenkanal	800	25.11.2025 to 30.11.2025	Ujjain- Omkareshwar
8	Sambalpur (8 Districts)	Sambalpur, Sundargarh, Balangir, Baragarh, Jharsuguda, Debagarh, Angul, Subarnapur	800	05.12.2025 to 10.12.2025	Rameshwaram - Madurai
9	Rayagada (6 Districts)	Rayagada, Koraput, Malkangiri, Nabarangpur, Kalahandi, Nuapada	800	15.12.2025 to 20.12.2025	Rameshwaram - Madurai
10	Baleshwar (5 Districts)	Baleshwar, Mayurbhanj, Kendujhar, Jajpur, Bhadrak	800	07.01.2026 to 12.01.2026	Rameshwaram - Madurai
		Total =	7994		



12.3.4 SJDY (Shree Jagannath Darshan Yojna)

The scheme is envisaged as a state-wide social welfare and pilgrimage facilitation initiative with coverage across all 30 districts of Odisha, ensuring equitable regional inclusion. It is designed to enable safe, dignified, and organized travel for vulnerable sections of society, particularly those who are economically disadvantaged and socially dependent.

Target beneficiaries under the scheme include economically weaker senior citizens in the age group of 60–75 years as well as widows of all age groups below 75 years, recognizing their limited financial capacity, reduced mobility, and need for social support. The scheme prioritizes inclusivity and social security by facilitating access to spiritual and cultural experiences that may otherwise remain inaccessible to these groups.

The duration of the scheme is four years, extending up to 31 March 2029, and will be implemented during the period from FY 2025–26 to FY 2028–29. This phased, multi-year approach allows for gradual scaling, administrative learning, and course correction based on implementation feedback.

In terms of coverage and scale, the scheme aims to benefit approximately 1,00,000 beneficiaries over its entire duration. A calibrated year-wise rollout has been planned to ensure operational readiness and smooth implementation. During FY 2025–26, the scheme will cover around 5,000 beneficiaries as a pilot and stabilization phase. This will be followed by a significant scale-up to 35,000 beneficiaries in FY 2026–27, 30,000 beneficiaries in FY 2027–28, and 35,000 beneficiaries in FY 2028–29, enabling optimal utilization of infrastructure and administrative capacity.

For effective logistics and cost optimization, districts have been categorized based on travel distance and stay requirements.

21 districts have been classified under the “Night Stay in Puri” category. Beneficiaries from these districts—namely Ganjam, Gajapati, Kandhamal, Boudh, Sambalpur, Bargarh, Deogarh, Jharsuguda, Sundargarh, Balangir, Subarnapur, Angul, Koraput, Rayagada, Nabarangpur, Malkangiri, Kalahandi, Nuapada, Balasore, Keonjhar, and Mayurbhanj—will require overnight accommodation due to longer travel distances. This category necessitates arrangements for lodging, meals, medical assistance, and escort support to ensure comfort and safety.

The remaining 9 districts—Puri, Khordha, Cuttack, Jagatsinghpur, Dhenkanal, Kendrapada, Nayagarh, Bhadrak, and Jajpur—fall under the “Same-Day Return (Day Travel)” category. Beneficiaries from these districts can undertake the journey and return within the same day, reducing the need for accommodation while still ensuring adequate transport, food, and on-ground facilitation.

Hon’ble Chief Minister of Odisha, Shri Mohan Charan Majhi, flagged off the Shri Jagannath Darshan Yojana (SJDY), a landmark initiative enabling economically weaker senior citizens and widows to undertake a safe and dignified pilgrimage to Shri Jagannath Dham, Puri. The programme was graced by Hon’ble Deputy Chief Minister Smt. Pravati Parida, Shri Nityananda Gond, Hon’ble Minister of School & Mass Education, ST & SC Development, Minorities & Backward Classes, and Dr. Mukesh Mahaling, Hon’ble Minister of Health & Family Welfare, along Hon’ble MLAs and Senior officials. The initiative was simultaneously launched through virtual flag-offs at Berhampur, Bhadrak, Sambalpur, Nabarangpur and Baripada, ensuring a coordinated rollout across the State.

No of Pilgrims actually travelled under SJDY				
Sl No	District Name	No. of Pilgrims actually travelled	Quota	Date/Period of Journey
1	Angul	131	148	07.03.2026- 08.03.2026
2	Balangir	170	185	10.03.2026- 11.03.2026
3	Balasore	223	259	11.03.2026- 12.03.2026
4	Baragarh	152	185	08.03.2026- 10.03.2026
5	Bhadrak	177	179	13.02.2026 & 10.03.2026
6	Boudh	71	74	08.03.2026- 10.03.2026
7	Cuttack	286	296	19.03.2026
8	Deogarh	36	37	10.03.2026- 11.03.2026
9	Dhenkanal	146	148	10.03.2026
10	Gajapati	66	74	07.03.2026- 08.03.2026
11	Ganjam	410	444	13.02.2026 & 17.03.2026
12	Jagatsinghpur	148	148	10.03.2026
13	Jajpur	143	185	07.03.2026- 08.03.2026
14	Jharsuguda	66	74	10.03.2026- 11.03.2026
15	Kalahandi	95	185	08.03.2026- 10.03.2026
16	Kandhamal	111	111	17.03.2026- 19.03.2026
17	Kendrapara	181	185	07.03.2026- 08.03.2026
18	Keonjhar	214	222	11.03.2026- 12.03.2026
19	Khordha	219	222	17.03.2026
20	Koraput	186	185	17.03.2026- 19.03.2026
21	Malkanagiri	74	74	17.03.2026- 19.03.2026
22	Mayurbhanj	296	323	13.02.2026 & 11.03.2026- 12.03.2026
23	Nabarangpur	146	148	13.02.2026
24	Nayagarh	84	111	07.03.2026- 08.03.2026
25	Nuapada	69	74	08.03.2026- 10.03.2026
26	Puri	142	185	19.03.2026
27	Rayagada	111	111	17.03.2026- 19.03.2026
28	Sambalpur	148	148	13.02.2026 & 08.03.2026- 10.03.2026
29	Subarnapur	73	74	17.03.2026- 19.03.2026
30	Sundergarh	177	222	10.03.2026- 11.03.2026
	Total =	4551	5016	

ADVENTURE TOUR

MoU SIGNING & GO-ADVENTURE PORTAL LAUNCH

IN AUGUST PRESENCE OF

SMT. PRAVATI KUMAR, DA,
DEPUTY CHIEF MINISTER, ODISHA

SEVA BHAVAN SWA

**12.3.5 Odisha Adventure
Tourism - 2025**



The Guidelines for Adventure Tourism were formally notified through a Gazette Notification, establishing a comprehensive regulatory framework for the planned and safe development of adventure tourism in the State. The Guidelines lay emphasis on tourist safety, operator accountability, environmental sustainability, and standardisation of adventure activities, while clearly defining roles and responsibilities of operators, training institutions, and the Government. Key provisions include mandatory registration of operators, activity-wise safety protocols, deployment of certified and trained manpower, insurance coverage for participants, equipment standards, periodic inspections, and a penalty framework for non-compliance, including suspension or cancellation of permissions in case of violations or incidents.

Following the notification, a dedicated online portal, Go-Adventure, was introduced to digitise and streamline the application, approval, renewal, and monitoring processes for adventure tourism activities, thereby enhancing transparency and ease of doing business. The portal has witnessed encouraging stakeholder response, with more than 20 applications received for water-based adventure activities within a short period of its operationalisation, reflecting growing interest in the regulated adventure tourism ecosystem.

To strengthen institutional capacity and ensure uniform skill development aligned with national and international standards, an agreement has been executed between the Tourism Department and OSWALI for facilitating structured training, assessment, and certification of adventure tourism personnel. In parallel, reputed organisations such as the National Institute of Water Sports (NIWS), Adventure Certification India (ACI), and the Indian Mountaineering Foundation (IMF) have been onboarded to undertake feasibility and site-suitability studies. Their technical expertise is being leveraged to assess proposed locations, activity viability, risk factors, and carrying capacity, ensuring that adventure tourism projects are implemented in accordance with best practices, safety norms, and environmental considerations, and contribute to the sustainable growth of the sector.

12.3.6 Guidelines for Leasing of Tourism Properties 2026

Department of Tourism, Govt. of Odisha has developed a number of accommodation properties – namely Panthanivas, Panthika, Yatri Nivas, Aranya Nivas, Tourist Reception Centre etc. – across key tourist destinations in the State. While most of the land parcels are located at strategic and scenic places, the development on these land parcels is not of adequate quality and does not help the Government of Odisha realise the tourism and commercial potential of the destination. Also, currently the land parcels are grossly under-developed and full potential has not been realised.

Govt. of Odisha has decided to lease out its accommodation properties and vacant land parcels owned by Department of Tourism to interested and eligible private operators for effective Operations and Management, as well as augmentation and redevelopment in specific cases, where land parcel has not been optimally utilized. The lessee will be permitted and obligated to develop the property into a star Category accommodation to ensure optimum utilization of the property / land parcel. Salient features of the guidelines are as follows:

- a. Every property must go through online competitive bidding
- b. Sub leasing clause applicable
- c. Non-hospitality developers will have to demonstrate double technical and financial capacity than the Hospitality players while participating for the bid. This subtly filters out speculative real estate players.
- d. Formation of SPV is mandatory.
- e. Lease period begins only after conditions precedent are fulfilled, not on LoA or LDA signing.
- f. Lease extension is not automatic.
- g. 'As-is-where-is' reversion protects interest of Department of Tourism.

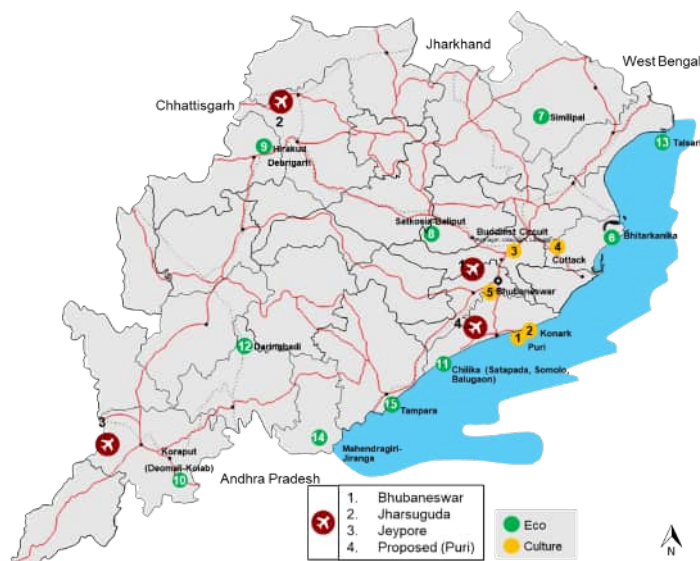


12.4 Infrastructure Development - State Projects

12.4.1 Integrated Tourism Masterplans

Thematic Masterplans for conceptualization initiated and executing agencies identified (Buddhist Circuit, Forest related masterplans (Satkosia, Bhitarkanika, Chilika, Mahendragiri, Similipal etc.

Sl	Category	Destinations	District
1	Culture	Puri	Puri
2		Konark	
3		Buddhist Circuit	Jajpur-Cuttack
4		Cuttack	Cuttack
5		Bhubaneswar	Khordha
6	Ecotourism	Bhitarkanika	Kendrapara
7		Similipal	Mayurbhanj
8		Satkosia-Baliput	Cuttack
9		Hirakud-Debrigarh	Sambalpur-Bargarh
10		Koraput (Deomali-Kolab)	Koraput
11		Chilika (Satapada, Somolo, Balugaon)	Khordha-Puri-Ganjam
12		Daringbadi	Kandhamal
13		Talasari - Bichitrapur	Balasore
14		Mahendragiri-Jiranga	Gajapati
15		Tampara - Gopalpur	Ganjam



Sl	Category	Destinations	District	Proposed Developments
1	Culture	Puri-Konark	Puri	• Development of projects under ABADHA scheme • Konark destination development • Shamuka Project to be proposed as a Global Destination • Proposed cruise terminal at Mangala river beach/ Baliarchandi • Connectivity to Puri-Konark (Rail, Coastal Highway, Airport etc) • Identification of investible land bank at Konark
2		Buddhist Circuit	Jajpur-Cuttack	• OBCC has been entrusted for preparation of integrated masterplan for Buddhist circuit – Lalitgiri, Udayagiri, Ratnagiri • Land for private investment identified
3		Cuttack	Cuttack	• Mahanadi riverfront, Cuttack Water metro • Filigree market • District Museum • Barabati fort masterplan
4		Dhauli	Khordha	• Holistic development around Peace, Wellness and Buddhism • Land for private investment identified



Sl	Category	Destinations	District	Proposed Developments
5	Ecotourism			
6		Bhitarkanika	Kendrapara	- Integrated Plazas holistic development by DoFE&CC- Dangamal, Gupti, Khola, Penth - Other infrastructure like Inland water, cruise terminal through IWAI, IWT, Homestays etc - Land for private investment identified
		Simlipal	Mayurbhanj	- Integrated Plazas holistic development by DoFE&CC at Pithabata, Talabandha and Kalikaprasad - Land for private investment identified
7		Satkosia-Baliput	Cuttack	- Integrated Plazas holistic development by DoFE&CC- Baliput, Chhamundia, Jagannathpur, Kusanga entry points - Land for private investment identified
8		Hirakud-Debrigarh	Sambalpur-Bargarh	- Hirakud Integrated masterplan - OCC entrusted for SASCI components – Execution initiated - State components tendered by OTDC – Architect on board for DPR preparation - DoFE&CC – Debrigarh DPR shared by DFO for approval to DoT - Land for private investment identified
9		Deomali	Koraput	- Land for private investment identified - Masterplan preparation in progress by OTDC. Project proposed to be sent to MoT for approval under Central Scheme – Swadesh Darshan Hilltop – forest clearance required for development
10		Kolab	Koraput	- Land for private investment identified - Infrastructure components in progress by OTDC related to water sports
11		Chilika	Khordha-Puri-Ganjam	- CDA to initiate development. Satapada to be developed in 1st phase - Land identified for private investment.
12		Daringbadi	Kandhamal	- Land identified for private investment. - Masterplan to be initiated
13		Talasari	Balasore	- Land identified for private investment at Bichitrapur Promenade nearing completion – Vending zone and parking area enhancement proposal initiated - Land for private investment identified at Bichitrapur
14		Mahendragiri-Jiranga	Gajapati	DFO has selected Architectural agency for preparation of DPR. Land identified for private investment
15		Tampara	Ganjam	Investible land identified at Aryapalli area

12.4.2 State Funded Projects

103 nos. tourism projects across 22 districts worth ~INR 34,623.11 Lakhs sanctioned to various executing agencies.

Projects approved from April-2025 to March-2026			
Sl.	District	Number of Projects	Sanction Amount (In Lakhs)
1	Balangir	4	3933.13
2	Balasore	4	692.90
3	Bargarh	3	926.79
4	Bhadrak	2	276.82
5	Cuttack	10	2,088.87
6	Deogarh	1	692.23
7	Gajapati	1	44.60
8	Ganjam	3	1,050.00
9	Jagatsinghpur	4	1,075.00
10	Jajpur	2	902.52
11	Jharsuguda	1	156.28
12	Kalahandi	1	294.20
13	Kandhamal	1	100.00
14	Khordha	11	3,226.98
15	Koraput	5	2,467.50
16	Malkangiri	1	294.67
17	Mayurbhanj	3	2,454.92
18	Nabarangpur	3	719.70
19	Nayagarh	2	300.00
20	Puri	34	11,793.35
21	Sambalpur	6	840.61
22	Sundargarh	1	292.04
Grand Total		103	34,623.11

12.4.3 Specialized Museums / Interpretation Centres (Proposed)

Department of tourism has proposed initiatives like

1. Hirakud – Dam Museum, Mine Museum, Energy Experience Centre
2. Chilika – Bird Museum at Mangalajodi
3. Forest Interpretation centres – Bhitarkanika, Mahendragiri, Simlipal, Satkosia etc
4. Tribal interpretation centres – Mayurbhanj, Koraput
5. District Museums – Deogarh, Balasore, Mayurbhanj, Koraput

to Provide a complete experience on meuseum & interpretation centre

12.4.4 Heritage conservation

MoU signed with IIT Madras for heritage conservation for structural audit of heritage properties (Proposed for Breakfast Island Chilika; Potagarh Fort, Ganjam; BN Palace, Paralakhemundi, Raja Bhakri, Sambalpur)

12.4.5 Beachfront developments initiated in line with Blue Flag guidelines

Department of Tourism (DoT) intends to develop and upgrade select beaches in Odisha in alignment with Blue Flag certification standards, with a focus on environmental sustainability, safety, cleanliness, accessibility, and high-quality visitor amenities. The proposed interventions emphasize scientific beach management, protection of coastal ecosystems, provision of adequate sanitation and waste management systems, water quality monitoring, lifesaving and safety infrastructure, and inclusive facilities for all visitors. Through this approach, DoT aims to position Odisha's beaches as globally benchmarked, eco-friendly destinations while enhancing tourist experience, promoting responsible coastal tourism, and strengthening the State's blue economy outcomes.



Sl.	District	Name of Beach	Executing Agency
1	Balasore	Talsari	R&B Balasore
2		Chandipur	R&B Balasore
3		Kasafal	Divisional Forest Officer (DFO)
4	Puri	Chandrabhaga (Shops and Café)	Odisha Tourism Development Corporation (OTDC)
5		Phulpatna	Divisional Forest Officer (DFO)
6		Beleswar	Divisional Forest Officer (DFO)
7		Astaranga	Divisional Forest Officer (DFO)
8		Shree Beach	Odisha Mining Corporation
9	Ganjam	Gopalpur	Berhampur Development Authority (BeDA)
10		Biju Pattnaik Beach	Divisional Forest Officer (DFO)
11	Kendrapara	Pentha	Divisional Forest Officer (DFO)
12	Jagatsinghpur	Paradeep	Odisha State Police Housing & Welfare Corporation (OPHWC)

12.4.6 Heritage Craft and WEAVERS' Villages of National Importance

The Department of Tourism proposes focused development of identified Heritage Craft and Weavers' Villages of National Importance to preserve Odisha's rich artisanal legacy while creating sustainable livelihood opportunities through tourism. The program emphasizes conservation of traditional art forms, upgradation of artisan workspaces, visitor infrastructure, capacity building, branding and market linkages, and community-led tourism models. Collectively, these interventions aim to enhance the visibility of Odisha's crafts at the national level, improve artisan incomes, and integrate cultural heritage into the State's sustainable tourism ecosystem. The weaver's/ art and craft villages in focus are as below-

1. Raghurajpur art and Craft village (Initiated)
2. Kardola, Sambalpur (Initiated)
3. Singpalli, Bargarh (Initiated)
4. Kotpad, Koraput (Initiated)
5. Guhaldihi, Mayurbhanj (Proposed)

12.5 Infrastructure Projects - Central Scheme Funding

Special Assistance to State for Capital Investment (SASCI) – Hirakud and Satkosia (~INR 100.00 Cr each) – Execution entrusted with OCC and DoFE&CC respectively

Hirakud – Proposed Projects under SASCI



Arrival Plaza



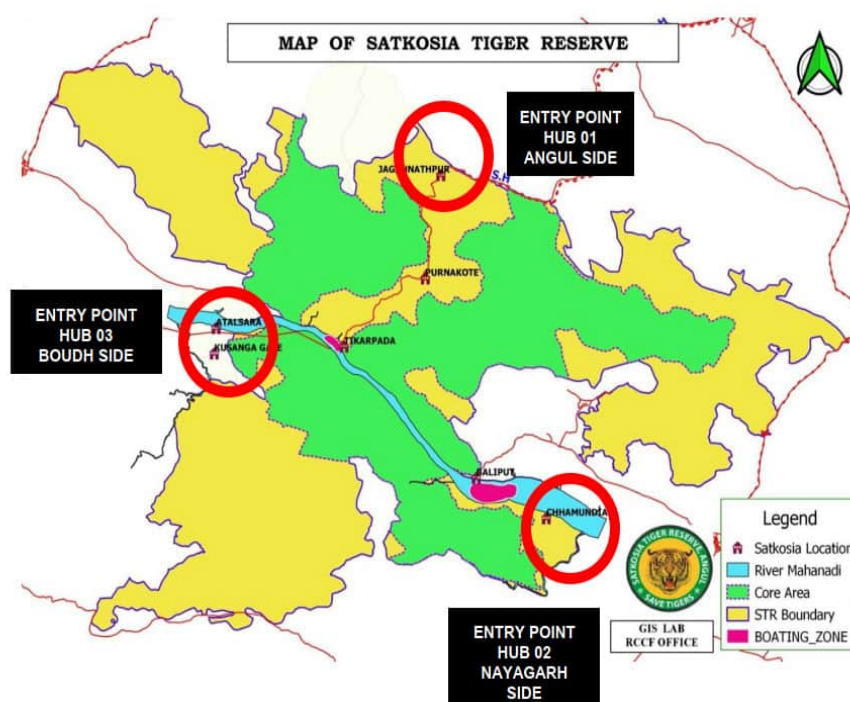
Light and Laser Symphony



Hirakud Dam Museum



Satkosia – Proposed Projects under SASCI



Other projects

Other projects proposed for Central funding – Funding support for tourism infrastructure development at Khiching, Deomali, and Ranipur Jharial – proposal/ request submitted to the Ministry of Tourism (MoT).

12.6 Tourism Land Bank For Hospitality Infrastructure

Department of Tourism (DoT) has identified Ac 5468.74 of land in coordination with District Administrations & IDCO at 15 major & other destinations for Tourism Master Plan & attracting private investments in hospitality sector aligning with the objectives of the Odisha Vision – 2036 & 2047.



SI	Destination	District	Govt. Land (In Acre)	Pvt. Land (In Acre)	Total Land (In Acre)	Cost (in INR Cr)
1	Satkosia - Baliput	Cuttack	139.20	103.10	242.30	18.13
2	Deomali	Koraput	47.78	50.35	98.13	7.09
3	Kolab	Koraput	360.99	-	360.99	7.94
4	Daringbadi	Kandhamal	51.69	50.00	101.69	140.49
5	Chilika	Puri, Khordha	117.53	299.37	416.90	156.79
6	Bhitarkanika	Bhadrak	149.60	-	149.60	3.29
7	Hirakud	Sambalpur, Bargarh, Jharsuguda	931.49	-	931.49	307.39
8	Buddhist Circuit	Jajpur	41.24	321.12	362.36	76.67
9	Talsari	Balasore	45.00	-	45.00	1.98
10	Simlipal	Mayurbhanj	198.78	56.29	255.07	7.46
11	Jiranga	Gajapati	25.77	-	25.77	0.28
12	Tampara- Aryapalli	Ganjam	109.30	124.25	233.55	147.57
13	Dhauli	Khordha	4.34	26.11	30.45	392.08
14	Shamuka	Puri	1,515.45	-	1,515.45	-
15	Konark	Puri	700.00	-	700.00	231.00
Total			4438.15	1939.58	5468.74	1498.17

12.7 Approval of Tourism Hospitality Projects from April 2025 to March 2026

Sl.	Type of Project	No of Projects Approved
1	Resort	16
2	3 Star Resort	5
3	4 Star Resort	5
4	5 Star Resort	2
5	Eco Resort	1
6	Eco Luxury Resort	1
7	3 Star Hotel	9
8	4 Star Hotel	8
9	5 Star Hotel	7
10	Motel	6
11	Motel & Convention Centre	1
12	Amusement Park	1
13	Tented Accommodation	1
14	Houseboat	1
15	Water Park	1
16	5 Star Hotel & Convention Unit	1
Total		66



12.8 Capital Investment Subsidy Disbursed

Sl. No	Name of Project	Amount (in Cr)
1	Vikash Eco Resorts Pvt. Ltd, Houseboat, barkul	0.67
2	Mayfair Palm Resort, Gopalpur	20
3	Specadi Resort, Gopalpur	4.59
4	Puri Seafarers Pvt Ltd, Cuttack	0.13
5	Pravat Hospitality, Puri	20
6	Mayfair Hotels and Resorts Ltd, Jharsuguda	20
7	Padma Eastern Hotels Pvt Ltd	4.95
8	Deomali Eco Tourism Pvt Ltd	0.34
Total		70.68



12.9 Safety, Security And Sanitation

Funds placed with respective District Administrations for enhancing cleanliness, hygiene, and safety at 55 nos. high footfall tourist destinations across the state, including beaches, religious sites, heritage spots, hills, and craft villages. Model RFP for onboarding of CFMS Agency shared with all TDOs.

List of 55 destinations:

Sl.	District Name	Destination Name
1	Angul	Satakosia
2	Balangir	Harishankar
3	Balangir	Ranipur Jharial
4	Balasore	Chandaneswar
5	Balasore	Talasari
	Balasore	Udayapur
6	Balasore	Chandipur
7	Bargarh	Nrusinghnath
8	Bhadrak	Aradi
9	Cuttack	Dhabaleswar
10	Cuttack	Ansupa
11	Cuttack	Lalitgiri
12	Deogarh	Pradhanpat
13	Dhenkanal	Kapilash
14	Ganjam	Tara Tarini
15	Ganjam	Rambha Chilika
16	Ganjam	Tampara
17	Ganjam	Gopalpur
18	Ganjam	Sonapur
19	Jagatsinghpur	Paradeep
20	Jagatsinghpur	Maa Sarala Temple
21	Jajpur	Maa Biraja Temple, Jajpur
22	Jajpur	Baraha Peetha
23	Jajpur	Udayagiri
24	Jajpur	Ratnagiri
25	Kandhamal	Duluri
	Kandhamal	Lovers Point
	Kandhamal	Pattabandha Waterfall
26	Keonjhar	Ghatagaon
27	Khordha	Barkul
28	Khordha	Dhuli

Sl.	District Name	Destination Name
29	Khordha	Khandagiri-Udayagiri
30	Koraput	Deomali
	Koraput	Gupteswar
31	Koraput	Duduma Waterfall
	Koraput	Onukadeli
32	Kendrapara	Bhitarkanika-Dangamal
	Kendrapara	Bhitarkanika-Gupti
	Kendrapara	Bhitarkanika-Khola
33	Nayagarh	Kantilo
34	Mayurbhanj	Khiching
35	Mayurbhanj	Devkund
	Mayurbhanj	Sitakund
36	Puri	Satapada
37	Puri	Baliharachandi & Alaranth
38	Puri	Raghurajpur
39	Puri	Puri
40	Puri	Pir Jahania Astaranga
41	Puri	Kakatapur
42	Sambalpur	Hirakud
43	Sambalpur	Maa Samaleswari temple
44	Sambalpur	Huma
45	Sundargarh	Khandadhar
46	Sundargarh	Vedavyas
47	Balasore	Panchalingeswar
48	Balasore	Remuna
49	Balasore	Dagara
50	Dhenkanal	Joranda
51	Ganjam	Biju Patnaik Beach
52	Jajpur	Langudi
53	Malkangiri	Satiguda
54	Mayurbhanj	Bhimkund
55	Subarnapur	Binika

12.10 Safety And Security Of Tourists & Beach Cleaning

Safe, secure & hassle-free movement of tourists within Odisha is the top-most priority of the Department of Tourism. Puri being the hub of tourist movement, the State Government has taken the following measures.

1. 95 lifeguards have been now deployed along the sea beach in Puri by the Home Department. The lifeguards, controlled by Commandant Home Guard Puri and monitor & Supervise by Odisha Fire Department, are deployed to prevent drowning, Rescue purposes and protect lives of tourists at sea beaches in Puri. Expenditure towards deployment of lifeguards is being borne by the Home Department. Lifesaving equipments and Uniforms have also been provided to the Lifeguards by Tourism Department.
2. Four Tourist Police Patrolling vehicles have been engaged in Puri-Konark and Puri-Satapada routes. The expenditure in this regard is borne by Tourism Department.
3. Home Department has created Tourist Police Cells at eight Police Stations in the State viz. Sea Beach Police Station (Puri), Brahmagiri Police Station (Satapada), Konark Police Station (Chandrabhaga) in Puri Police District, Nandankanan Police Station (Nandankanan), Dhauli Police Station (Dhauli), Shree Lingaraj Police Station (Shree Lingaraj Temple) in UPD, Bhubaneswar, Gopalpur Police Station (Gopalpur) in Berhampur Police District, Chandipur Police Station (Chandipur) in Balasore Police District vide letter no.17521(M)/ D & A dtd. 29.05.2015. 72 posts have been created in different categories like SA-8, ASI-8, Havildar-8 and Constable-48. All Tourist Police Cells have been operationalized.
4. The Home Department has established Tourist Police Cells at eight key locations across the State—Puri, Satapada, Chandrabhaga, Nandankanan, Dhauli, Shree Lingaraj Temple, Gopalpur, and Chandipur—with a total sanctioned strength of 72 personnel, all of which are fully operational. Building on this strong foundation, the Department of Tourism has proposed a significant expansion of tourist policing infrastructure to cover 29 high-footfall locations across the State, comprising 8 existing and 21 new locations. With a total deployment of 403 personnel, this initiative aims to further strengthen safety, security, and visitor facilitation, ensuring a more robust, responsive, and tourist-friendly policing framework to support the State's growing tourism sector.
5. The Department of Tourism has sanctioned INR 50 Crore for FY 2025-26 to enhance cleanliness, hygiene, and safety at various tourist destinations, including beaches, religious sites, heritage spots and hills across 30 districts of Odisha.

13. Training & Capacity Building

Department of Tourism conducts various training & capacity building activities on different aspects of tourism regularly. Indian Institute of Tourism & Travel Management (IITTM), Bhubaneswar has conducted the following trainings in the FY-2025-26:

- I. 69 Tourist Police Personnel have undertaken orientation training programme
- II. 30 Managers and Assistant Managers of OTDC have undertaken the Management Development Programme on Hospitality and Marketing Skills.
- III. 100 Lifeguard of Chandrabhaga / Ramchandi Beach, Konark have undertaken the 10-days Certification Programme at Ramchandi, Konark
- IV. 106 State Level Tourist Guides have undertaken the Refresher Course for State Level Tourist Guides.
- V. 50 numbers of Lifeguards of Lifeguard Association of Jhania, Astaranga have undertaken the Tourism Orientation training Programme at Jahania Beach, Astaranga.
- VI. 60 numbers of Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Youths of Mayurbhanj district have undertaken the training programme on Ethnic and Eco-Tourism Facilitation at Baripada.



14 • Introduction Of Niche Tourism Products

14.1 Caravan Tourism on VGF mode – Partner onboarded

As part of its ongoing efforts to diversify tourism offerings and promote experiential travel, the Department of Tourism has introduced Caravan Tourism as a new niche and luxury tourism product in Odisha. This initiative aims to provide high-quality, mobile accommodation solutions for group and FIT travellers, particularly in destinations where conventional star-category hotels are limited. Implemented through the Odisha Tourism Development Corporation (OTDC) under a Viability Gap Funding (VGF) model, the project envisages owning, operating and managing fully equipped motor caravans at strategically identified destinations across the State, including coastal, eco, wildlife, hill and offbeat circuits. The initiative is being supported by the development of dedicated Caravan Parks and essential infrastructure in coordination with line departments. The caravans are designed to offer premium amenities, safety-compliant operations and curated itineraries within Odisha, thereby enhancing tourist dispersal, extending length of stay, and generating local livelihood opportunities, while positioning Odisha as a progressive destination for innovative and sustainable tourism experiences.



14.2 Odisha Walks – partner onboarded

As part of its initiatives to promote immersive, experience-led tourism, the Department of Tourism has launched "Odisha Walks", a curated destination trail programme aimed at showcasing the State's cultural, natural and heritage assets through guided thematic walks. Implemented through Odisha Tourism Development Corporation (OTDC), the programme covers Koraput, Daringbadi, Similipal, Baripada, Bhubaneswar, Cuttack, Sambalpur, Puri and RUL are designed to operate year-round. Under this initiative, professional agencies are engaged As part of its initiatives to promote immersive, experience-led tourism, the Department of Tourism has launched "Odisha Walks", a curated destination trail programme aimed at showcasing the State's cultural, natural and heritage assets through guided thematic walks. Implemented through Odisha Tourism Development Corporation (OTDC), the programme covers Koraput, Daringbadi, Similipal, Baripada, Bhubaneswar, Cuttack, Sambalpur, Puri and RUL are designed to operate year-round. Under this initiative, professional agencies are engaged for conceptualization and execution of curated trails including tribal and indigenous food walks, heritage and archaeological trails, Buddhist circuit walks, nature and eco-experience trails, wildlife and birding walks, ethnobotany trails, and cultural art and craft walks. The programme aims to provide authentic, interpretative experiences to visitors while promoting local culture, biodiversity and history, enhancing tourist engagement beyond conventional sightseeing, improving destination visibility, and encouraging sustainable and community-linked tourism practices across diverse regions of Odisha.





Sitakund...

15. Awards and Recognitions

- 1 **"Best Culinary Destination"** at Travel + Leisure India's Best Awards 2025
- 2 Odisha was awarded for conserving and promoting its Living Heritage at Heritage Awards 2025 by The Week
- 3 **"Best Beach Destination Award"** was awarded to Puri Blue Flag Beach by India Today at the India Today Tourism Survey and Awards 2025
- 4 **"Most Promising New Destination Award"** was awarded at TTF Ahmedabad



5 Odisha Tourism Branding

- a. Implementation of a comprehensive branding campaign through onboarding of a professional agency.

6 Promotion of Odia Cuisine

- a. Engagement of a brand ambassador to promote Odia cuisine in the initial phase.
- b. Launch of an international Odia cuisine festival along with institutionalized food awards.
- c. Creation of a specialized food-focused R&D centre to support innovation, standardization, and global positioning.

7 Digital outreach

- a. Engagement of a digital strategy partner to design, implement, and monitor an integrated digital outreach plan.

8 Highway Drive in Facilities

- a. Operationalisation of 70 Wayside Amenity Centres.
- b. Collaboration with petrol pumps for the provision of clean and hygienic toilets, aimed at improving the existing condition of highway washrooms in Odisha. Development of a software-based system for real-time availability and mapping of toilets across highways.
- c. Preparation and implementation of a marketing plan to ensure wider visibility and public awareness

9 Promotion of Caravan Tourism

- a. Upgradation and operationalization of Ecotour nature camps to function as caravan-friendly parks.
- b. Conduct of curated FAM trips for FTOs and key influencers/celebrities to promote caravan tourism destinations.

10 Marquee Events

- a. Hirakud Floating festival
- b. Puri-Konark Coastal marathon
- c. Chilika Bird festival
- d. International Odia Food Festival

11 Ranking of sanitation across identified tourist centres

- a. Engagement of an independent agency to undertake sanitation and safety ranking of identified tourist centres and administer an awards framework linked to performance.

16. Recognition Of Excursion Agencies

50 Nos. of Travel Agencies / Tour Operators have been recognized under Tourism department

MAHENDRA

SECOND HIGHEST PEAK
in Odisha



DRAGIRI





ODISHA
THINK INDIA, THINK ODISHA.

Department of Tourism, Govt. of Odisha, Paryatan Bhawan, Lewis Road
Bhubaneswar - 751014, Ph: 0674-2432177/2431896, Fax: 0674 - 2430887
info@odishatourism.gov.in | www.odishatourism.gov.in

 [odishatourismofficial](https://www.facebook.com/odishatourismofficial)  [odishatourismofficial](https://www.instagram.com/odishatourismofficial)  [odisha_tourism](https://twitter.com/odisha_tourism)